

# Murder Mystery

*Dinner Party 2026*

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## Elle Loominate

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*The Meridian Museum*

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

# INTRODUCTIONS



Elle Loominate

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## *Textile Artist & Designer*

Elle has identified every fabric in the room, including the suspiciously shiny tuxedo. Elle turns weaving, embroidery, salvage fabric, and obsessive handwork into installations that critics call intimate and collectors call surprisingly difficult to ship.

- Has helped **Dada DiCapo** build several installations.
- Asks **Chip Patina** how to display fragile textiles without making the supports the main attraction.
- Has worked in **Frank Lloyd Wrong**'s exhibition spaces. **Frank**'s empty walls look like opportunities to Elle.

## ACTING TIPS

Creative, grounded, quietly funny, detail-oriented. You notice what people wear and how things are made.

## YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Elle Loominate. I make installations with light and fabric. Please do not describe either as something your nephew could do.

*Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.*

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## Behind the portrait

### Your grievance with Grant

Grant intended to purchase a family-owned ceremonial textile you had borrowed for your installation, despite your refusal to sell.

### Your other secret

The textile is in the exhibition without the full paperwork your family expected because you were afraid the loan would be denied.

### Conversations to start

- Ask Chip Patina how you can protect the ceremonial textile without selling it.
- Ask Dada DiCapo whether the gala has become more about donors than artists.

*One attending guest committed the murder alone. Follow your printed account during the hearings. If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else.*

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don't share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.  
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



# The game is afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

- 1 *Dietrich's story belongs on a bookshelf. Tonight something else belongs between its covers.*
- 2 *No petals are needed: the vase holds a different kind of arrangement.*
- 3 *A clue watches the cars come and go from above the garage door.*



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**  
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



# Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament**

What did Grant demand from you, and what had you already concealed?

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**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir**

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

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**Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid**

What hidden transaction made Grant a threat to you?

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**Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions**

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

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**Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme**

What truth did Grant want suppressed, and what could embarrass you?

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**Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop**

What did Grant ask you to hide?

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**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist**

What compromise in your work gave Grant leverage over you?

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**Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks**

What did you want returned or protected?

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**Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What past agreement was about to become a public dispute?

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**Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote**

How did Grant threaten your work, and how did you respond?

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*Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.*

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## Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.  
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

### IF INNOCENT

The loan paperwork is incomplete because I feared my family would refuse. Grant then offered to buy the textile as if that solved consent. It isn't a decorative opportunity. People in my family remember who made it, and none of those names is Grant.

### IF MURDERER

I brought the textile without all the family paperwork. Grant saw that weakness and announced he would purchase it. I told him it wasn't for sale. He answered with a larger number. He treated consent like a reserve price he hadn't reached yet.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**  
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



## Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Paige Turner / Justin Tyme**

What task or errand occupied you before the toast?

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**Claire O'Scuro / Vincent Van Faux / Saul D. Bid**

How did you approach Grant about your papers or work?

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**Hugh Bidder / Tess Tament / Anya Tique / Ella Gance**

When did you first enter, and what business did you have with Grant?

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**Monet Bags / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks**

Describe your errand at the private service station.

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**Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates**

What physical work or problem occupied you?

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**Dada DiCapo / Dr. Art E. Fact / Elon Mosaic**

What did Grant want changed, and how did you respond before the toast?

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**Sue Venir / Elle Loominate / Reed DeLabel**

Why did you contact the preparation department, and how did you collect your papers?

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**Barb Dwyer / Frank Lloyd Wrong / Minnie Malist**

What practical museum duty were you handling?

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**Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Penny Pincher**

What did you bring Grant, and what happened when you delivered it?

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**Anne E. Dote / Faye Stop**

How did your museum materials bring you through the preparation department?

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*Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.*

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### Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.  
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

#### IF INNOCENT

Conservation had the textile loan amendment. I stood at the west counter while the assistant hunted for our sleeve. I could see the corridor, a solid partition, and the assistant's increasingly irritated face. I took the returned sleeve straight to Grant. That counter exchange accounts for my whole contact with preparation.

#### IF MURDERER

I brought the textile's incomplete loan papers to conservation. I went through the east visitor door to the shelves and retrieved the amended sleeve inside. Grant had mistaken possession for permission to buy. My family had lent an object, not appointed me its auctioneer. I had left too much of that distinction unwritten.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**  
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



## Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

**Claire O'Scuro / Sue Venir / Dr. Art E. Fact**

What detail on your paperwork or its packaging should we notice?

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**Artie Ficial / Tess Tament / Minnie Malist**

What did you handle around the speech or service preparations?

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**Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid**

What original record or material completes your account of the dispute?

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**Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates**

When did that work or interruption end, and what were your materials used for?

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**Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Elle Loominate**

What physical detail completes your account of the work you wanted protected?

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**Monet Bags / Anya Tique / Penny Pincher**

What was on the material you brought, and what does it actually record?

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**Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks**

What did your access or service arrangements actually involve?

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**Paige Turner / Drew Conclusions / Faye Stop**

Which original or retained material did you handle, and what marks does it bear?

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**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Reed DeLabel / Anne E. Dote**

What does the completed work or return record tell us?

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**Mona Lott / Ella Gance / Justin Tyme**

What detail on the original paper or record confirms the sequence you described?

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*Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.*

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## Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.  
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

### IF INNOCENT

The sleeve carries the WEST RETURN stamp. The amendment came through the staff slot into my hands. LOAN is written in full-sized letters. Grant wanted to call that word a clerical error. For once, the clerical work was excellent.

### IF MURDERER

EAST VISITOR is stamped on the sleeve. I retrieved it from the shelves inside. The amendment says LOAN in full-sized letters. Grant wanted to call that word a clerical error. For once, the clerical work was excellent.

*The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.*



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.  
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# Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

## Your character name

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## I accuse

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## Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

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## Best Actor

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## Best Costume

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# The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

## IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

The incomplete papers were my mistake. I have now made the loan explicit, and the textile will return to my family. My only preparation contact was across the west return barrier. I never reached the source shelves. Grant could dispute the loan's wording; that did not put cyanide in my hands.

## IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I took cyanide after joining the walkthrough and carried it in the loan sleeve. While the glass was uncovered I spread the amendment beside Grant's glass and applied the solution inside the glass. He treated my refusal as bargaining. I answered with murder. Returning the textile cannot undo the act I chose in its name.

*Every selected suspect gets their final word.*